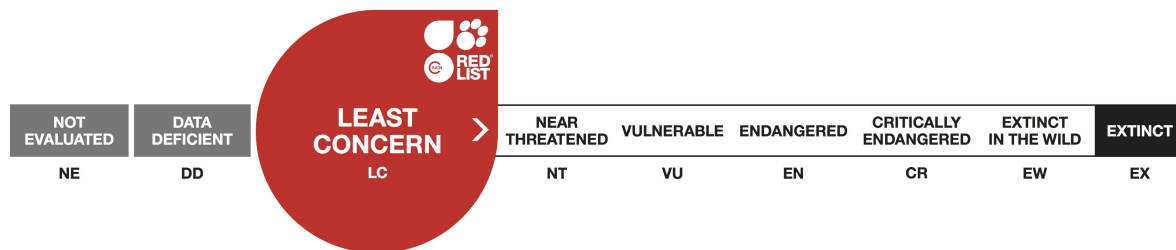


Eurypharynx pelecanoides, Pelican Eel

Assessment by: Iwamoto, T.



View on www.iucnredlist.org

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Actinopterygii	Saccopharyngiformes	Eurypharyngidae

Taxon Name: *Eurypharynx pelecánoides* Vaillant, 1882

Regional Assessments:

- [Europe](#)

Common Name(s):

- English: Pelican Eel, Big-mouth Gulper, Deep-sea Gulper Eel, Gulper, Gulper Eel, Pelican Fish, Pelican Gulper, Pelican Gulper Fish, Umbrellamouth Gulper
- French: Grand-gousier Pelican, Grandgousier Pélican
- Spanish: Pez Pelicano

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Least Concern [ver 3.1](#)

Year Published: 2015

Date Assessed: May 24, 2012

Justification:

Eurypharynx pelecánoides is circumglobally distributed and is commonly captured below 1,000 m off West Africa. It is an extremely deep-dwelling species that has no major threats. It is listed as Least Concern.

Geographic Range

Range Description:

Eurypharynx pelecánoides is circumglobally distributed in tropical and temperate waters. Recent records include the Gulf of Mexico, off Louisiana (McEachran *et al.* 1998). It is found at depths ranging from 500-7,625 m, although it is more typically found in waters ranging from 1,200-1,400 m (Masuda *et al.* 1984).

Country Occurrence:

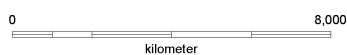
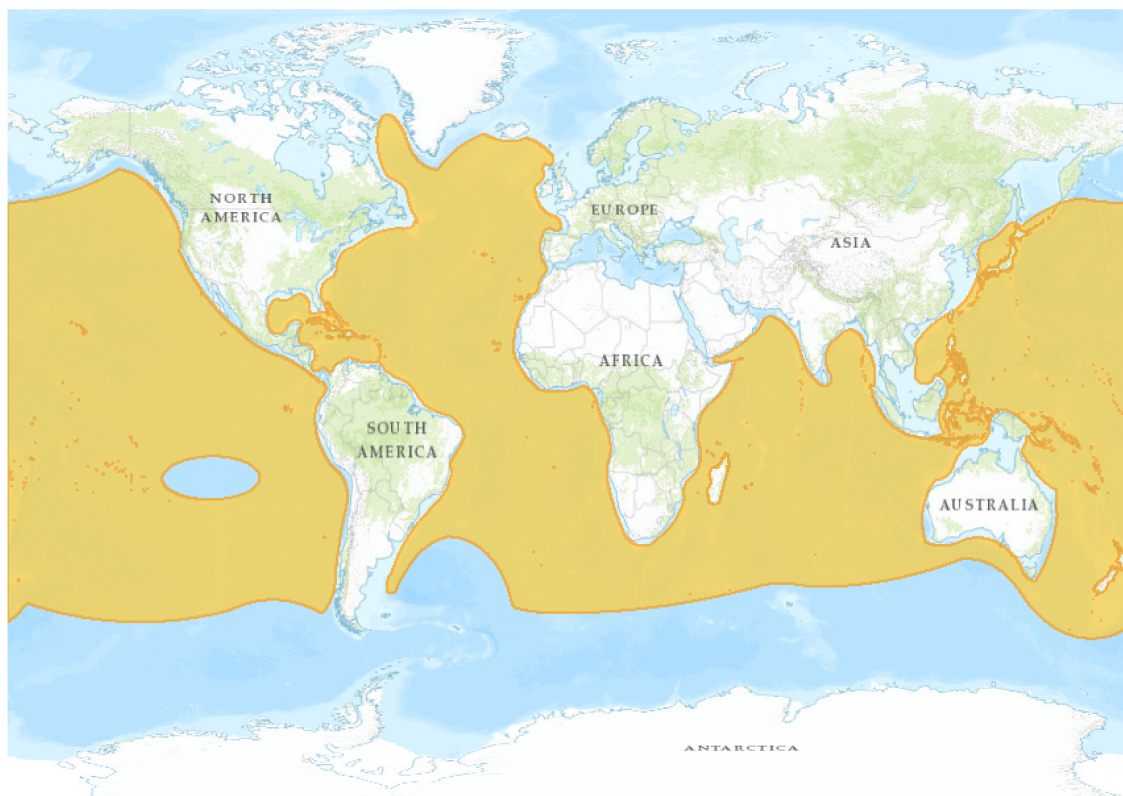
Native: American Samoa (American Samoa); Angola (Angola); Anguilla; Antigua and Barbuda; Argentina; Aruba; Australia (Macquarie Is.); Bahamas; Bangladesh; Barbados; Belize; Benin; Bermuda; Bonaire, Sint Eustatius and Saba; Brazil (Trindade); British Indian Ocean Territory; Canada; Cayman Islands; Chile (Easter Is.); China; Christmas Island; Cocos (Keeling) Islands; Colombia; Comoros; Congo; Cook Islands; Costa Rica; Côte d'Ivoire; Cuba; Curaçao; Disputed Territory (Paracel Is., Spratly Is.); Dominica; Dominican Republic; Ecuador (Galápagos); El Salvador; Equatorial Guinea; Faroe Islands; Fiji; France (Clipperton I.); French Guiana; French Southern Territories (Amsterdam-St. Paul Is., Crozet Is., Mozambique Channel Is.); Gabon; Gambia; Ghana; Greenland; Grenada; Guadeloupe; Guam; Guatemala; Guinea; Guinea-Bissau; Haiti; Honduras; Iceland; India (Andaman Is., Nicobar Is.); Indonesia; Ireland; Jamaica; Japan; Kenya; Kiribati (Kiribati Line Is., Phoenix Is.); Korea, Democratic People's Republic of; Korea, Republic of; Liberia; Malaysia; Maldives; Marshall Islands; Martinique; Mauritius;

Mayotte; Mexico; Micronesia, Federated States of ; Montserrat; Morocco; Mozambique; Myanmar; Namibia; Nauru; New Caledonia; New Zealand; Nicaragua; Nigeria; Niue; Norfolk Island; Northern Mariana Islands; Oman; Pakistan; Palau; Panama; Papua New Guinea; Peru; Philippines; Portugal (Azores, Madeira, Portugal (mainland)); Puerto Rico; Réunion; Russian Federation (Kuril Is.); Saint Helena, Ascension and Tristan da Cunha (Ascension, Saint Helena (main island), Tristan da Cunha); Saint Kitts and Nevis; Saint Lucia; Saint Martin (French part); Saint Pierre and Miquelon; Saint Vincent and the Grenadines; Samoa; Sao Tomé and Príncipe; Senegal; Seychelles; Sierra Leone; Sint Maarten (Dutch part); Solomon Islands; Somalia; South Africa (Marion-Prince Edward Is.); Spain (Canary Is., Spain (mainland)); Sri Lanka; Suriname; Taiwan, Province of China; Tanzania, United Republic of; Thailand; Togo; Tokelau; Tonga; Trinidad and Tobago; Turks and Caicos Islands; Tuvalu; United Kingdom; United States (Alaska, Hawaiian Is.); United States Minor Outlying Islands (Howland-Baker Is., Johnston I., Wake Is.); Uruguay; Vanuatu; Venezuela, Bolivarian Republic of; Viet Nam; Virgin Islands, British; Virgin Islands, U.S.; Wallis and Futuna; Western Sahara; Yemen

FAO Marine Fishing Areas:

Native: Atlantic - northeast, Atlantic - eastern central, Atlantic - Antarctic, Atlantic - western central, Atlantic - southwest, Atlantic - southeast, Atlantic - northwest, Indian Ocean - Antarctic, Indian Ocean - eastern, Indian Ocean - western, Pacific - western central, Pacific - southwest, Pacific - southeast, Pacific - northwest, Pacific - northeast, Pacific - eastern central

Distribution Map



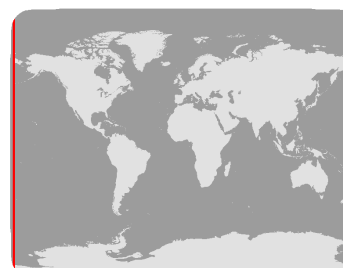
Sources: Esri, HERE, DeLorme, Intermap, increment P Corp., GEBCO, USGS, FAO, NPS, NRCAN, GeoBase, IGN, Kadaster NL, Ordnance Survey, Esri Japan, METI, Esri China (Hong Kong), swisstopo, MapmyIndia, © OpenStreetMap contributors, and the GIS User Community

Eurypharynx pelecanoides

Range

■ Extant (resident)

Compiled by:
International Union for
Conservation of Nature



The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply any official endorsement, acceptance or opinion by IUCN.



Population

Sampling undertaken as part of the census of marine life project, using double-warp midwater trawls revealed that *Eurypharynx pelecanoides* is a dominant component of the fish assemblage, contributing 4.6% of the total biomass collected at depths ranging from 750 to >2,300 m. This species was also found to be a dominant component of the near bottom assemblage between 1,500 and 2,300 m, accounting for 42% of the total biomass (Sutton *et al.* 2008). *Eurypharynx pelecanoides* is abundant in museum collections (542 lots). It is most frequently seen in single-specimen lots. Lots typically contain one to two individuals, however there are a few lots which contain many individuals (FishNet2 database searched March 2013). This species is commonly captured below 1,000 m off West Africa by the Nansen Surveys (Iwamoto pers. comm. 2013).

Current Population Trend: Unknown

Habitat and Ecology (see Appendix for additional information)

Eurypharynx pelecanoides is an indiscriminate feeder which feeds on a variety of prey items including crustaceans, fish and squid (Nielsen *et al.* 1989). This species is thought to be semelparous, breeding only once (Nielsen *et al.* 1989). This species is sexually dimorphic, with males developing a large, knob-like nasal rosette (Gartner 1983).

Systems: Marine

Use and Trade

This species is not utilized.

Threats

There are currently no threats to this species.

Conservation Actions

There are currently no species-specific conservation measures in place for this species.

Credits

Assessor(s): Iwamoto, T.

Reviewer(s): Weller, S., Strongin, K., Polidoro, B. & Carpenter, K.E.

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External Resources

For [Images and External Links to Additional Information](#), please see the [Red List website](#).

Appendix

Habitats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
10. Marine Oceanic -> 10.2. Marine Oceanic - Mesopelagic (200-1000m)	-	Suitable	-
10. Marine Oceanic -> 10.3. Marine Oceanic - Bathypelagic (1000-4000m)	-	Suitable	-
10. Marine Oceanic -> 10.4. Marine Oceanic - Abyssopelagic (4000-6000m)	-	Suitable	-

Additional Data Fields

Distribution
Lower depth limit (m): 7625
Upper depth limit (m): 500

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